

Defiant Netanyahu decries recognition of Palestine

In UN speech, says Israel will ‘finish the job’ against Hamas

By Ephrat Livni, Liam Stack, and Thomas Fuller

NEW YORK TIMES

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel ruled out calls for a Palestinian state during a combative speech at the United Nations in New York on Friday, saying the recognition of Palestine by more than 150 countries was “disgraceful” and vowing to “finish the job” against Hamas in the war in the Gaza Strip.

Netanyahu has for years rejected Palestinian statehood, but his address Friday, to a largely empty hall that seemed a metaphor for his country’s diplomatic

isolation, came at an especially tense time for his country. Israel has faced growing denunciation of its devastating conduct of the war in Gaza, and major Western nations including Britain, France, and Canada have recently recognized Palestine, after years of holding out against calls to do so.

“Israel will not allow you to shove a terror state down our throats,” Netanyahu told the sparse gathering. He said accepting an independent Palestine would be “national suicide” for Israel and that it would be a “mark of shame” for the countries that supported it, a group that includes the vast majority of the UN membership.

The United States is the sole member of the UN Security Council that has not recognized Palestine.

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For Trump, humiliating Comey may be the point

Legal analysts cite president’s own time in court, his words suggesting retribution

By Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — In March, President Trump delivered an unprecedented political speech at the Justice Department, declaring himself the nation’s “chief law enforcement officer” and putting his opponents on notice in a historic break with the agency’s long-held independence.

“We will ... very much expose their egregious crimes and severe misconduct,” he said. “It’s going to be legendary.”

Six months later, his administration has taken its biggest step toward fulfilling that promise: obtaining a federal grand jury indictment of former FBI director James Comey on charges he lied to Congress.

Legal experts said the case appeared to be weak. They noted that it only went forward after Trump publicly pressured Attorney General Pam Bondi to act and replaced the US attorney handling the matter with one of his former personal lawyers.

But the outcome might be less important to Trump than the legal process it has kicked off.

“It may be that Trump doesn’t care whether Comey is convicted, so long as he feels the personal pain and humiliation of being indicted and having to defend himself in court,” said Barbara McQuade, a University of Michigan law professor who served as a US attorney during the Obama administration.

Trump knows those feelings after facing several high-profile legal court cases in recent years, on top of twice being impeached.

FBI agents searched his Florida

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Big hopes for the power of little forests

Urban oases offer a lush respite in cities

By Edward Fitzpatrick

GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — The asphalt grid of South Providence is lined with multifamily homes and concrete sidewalks. But along Pearl Street, one lot stands out.

It’s lush and green, with nearly 270 trees packed into a 1,000-square-foot lot. Officially called the Pearl Street Garden, it contains a tiny forest in the middle of the urban jungle.

“Microforests” like this one are cropping up in places ranging from Elizabeth, N.J., to Cambridge, Mass., to Pakistan. South Providence has two, both along Pearl Street, created by Groundwork Rhode Island and the Pearl Street Garden Collective. The goal is to combat climate change and bring cooling shade to urban areas that lack the leafy boulevards of wealthier neighborhoods.

“This isn’t habitat restoration on the scale that is needed in terms of the world,” said Jacq Hall, director of special projects at Groundwork Rhode Island, an environmental group that works

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SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Lacey Kohler (left) and Cristiane Caro, cofounder of Pearl Street Garden Collective, in the Groundworks Rhode Island microforest in Providence.

ON TO PLAYOFFS FOR THE SOX



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Romy Gonzalez scored the winning run on Cedanne Rafaela’s walkoff triple Friday night, capping a comeback from a 3-0 deficit in a 4-3 win over the reeling Detroit Tigers and putting the Red Sox in the postseason for the first time since 2021. It’s still unclear who will be their opponent in the best of 3 wild-card round. **C1.**

A story of trauma, healing, and reunion

ICE detention brings back bad memories

By Katie Muchnick

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A sudden bang startled Paul Dama, a Nigerian television journalist on a reporting trip, as he drove along country roads from the Akwa Ibom State to Abuja State in his homeland. He thought it was a flat tire, but the sound was gunshots. Armed with machetes and guns, seven men appeared from the surrounding bushes.

Shooting at the vehicle, they instructed Dama and his two friends, who were riding with him, to exit the car and lie face down on the ground. Over the years, Dama, who worked for the Nigerian Television Authority, had covered countless deadly attacks by Boko Haram, the jihadist group that has killed thousands of Nigerians since launching

an insurgency in 2009. On Oct. 9, 2018, Dama and his friends became one of those stories when they were kidnapped by Boko Haram and held captive for four days.

After Dama was freed, his mother’s fervent wish was that he leave Nigeria for the United States to live with his younger sister. The 46-year-old Dama, who recounted his experiences in an interview with the Globe on Friday, never imagined that once he was free and living in the United States, he would again endure such a terrifying ordeal.

Dama, who became a manager at his family’s popular Boston-based Nigerian restaurant chain, Suva Joint, is one of approximately 2,800 people who have been arrested by ICE in Massachusetts between Janu-

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Suffolk sheriff’s officer facing trafficking charge

Another worker fired amid drug allegations

By Danny McDonald

GLOBE STAFF

A Suffolk County sheriff’s corrections officer was busted this summer for allegedly trafficking methamphetamine, and another employee for that office was recently fired for allegedly smuggling hundreds of thousands of dollars worth of a synthetic cannabinoid to an inmate in court.

The details of these incidents have not been previously reported, and they add to the controversies buffeting the sheriff’s department in recent weeks. In August, after federal prosecutors brought extortion charges against him, Suffolk County Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins announced he was going on leave. And just last week, a former Suffolk corrections officer was charged with raping an inmate at the South Bay House of Correction in July.

Fabrizio Rico, who turns 50 on Saturday, was arrested in July during a drug sting at his Haverhill home, according to court records, and currently faces drug distribution charges. His next court date is slated for Oct. 10 in Essex Superior Court, according to available online dockets.

Rico’s attorney, John Morris, declined to comment on the matter.

This summer, State Police investigators re-

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